

# The Computer Industry

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## Computing and Mathematics

May, 2026

# The Computer Industry (A04921)

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|---------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Short Title:</b> | The Computer Industry     |                            |
| <b>Faculty</b>      | Science and Computing     |                            |
| <b>Department</b>   | Computing and Mathematics |                            |
| <b>Cluster</b>      | Professional Skills       |                            |
| <b>Author</b>       | BLYNG                     |                            |
| <b>Credits</b>      | 5                         | <b>Level:</b> Introductory |

## Description of Module / Aims

The aim of this module is to introduce the student to the nature, structure, operating environment and markets of the major branches of the computer industry.

## Programmes

|           |                                                                    |           |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| COMP-0375 | BSc (Hons) in Applied Computing (International) (WD_KACMI_B)       | 1 / 1 / M |
| COMP-0375 | BSc (Hons) in Applied Computing (WD_KACCM_B)                       | 1 / 1 / M |
| COMP-0375 | BSc (Hons) in Applied Computing (WD_KCOMP_B)                       | 1 / 1 / M |
| COMP-0375 | BSc (Hons) in Computer Forensics and Security (WD_KCOFO_B)         | 1 / 1 / M |
| COMP-0375 | BSc (Hons) in Computer Science (WD_KCMSC_B)                        | 1 / 1 / M |
| COMP-0375 | BSc (Hons) in the Internet of Things (International) (WD_KINTT_BI) | 1 / 1 / M |

## Indicative Content

- Introduction and Overview
- Structure and organisation of the computing industry
- Marketing of high-technology products
- Market dynamics of the Computer Industry
- Intellectual Property Rights

## Learning Outcomes

*On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:*

1. Describe the organisational structure of key computer industry sectors.
2. Examine the macro and micro-environmental factors that impact the computer industry.
3. Examine the marketing strategies adopted by a company in the computer industry.
4. Distinguish between the various forms of intellectual property rights.
5. Express ideas and information clearly in visual, oral and written forms through in-class activities.

## Learning and Teaching Methods

- Interactive and open-forum lectures will be used to introduce new concepts and to consider the concepts' implications for module deliverables.
- Self-directed learning activities will require students to will reflect upon the module materials, diagnose their learning needs and conduct research to satisfy these needs.

## Assessment Methods

|                       | Weighing | Outcomes Assessed |
|-----------------------|----------|-------------------|
| Continuous Assessment | 100%     |                   |
| <i>Group Project</i>  | 40%      | 1,2,5             |
| <i>Group Project</i>  | 60%      | 3,4,5             |

## Assessment Criteria

**<40%:** Unable to interpret and describe key concepts of the computing industry.

**40%-49%:** Be able to interpret and describe key concepts of the specific knowledge domain(s).

**50%-59%:** All the above and in addition demonstrate the ability to discuss key concepts of the computing industry and ability to discover and integrate related knowledge in other knowledge domains.

**60%-69%:** In addition, be able to solve problems within the computing industry by experimenting with the appropriate skills and tools.

**70%-100%:** 1: All the above to an excellent level. Be able to analyse and design solutions to a high standard for a range of both complex and unforeseen problems through the use and modification of appropriate skills and tools.

## Learning Modes

| Learning Mode        | F/T Hours | P/T Hours |
|----------------------|-----------|-----------|
| Lecture              | 36        |           |
| Independent Learning | 99        |           |

## Supplementary Material

- "The Guardian Technology." <http://www.guardian.co.uk/technology>
- Arthur, C. *\_Digital Wars: Apple, Google, Microsoft and the Battle for the Internet\_*. London: Kogan Page, 2012.
- Brynjolfsson, E. and A. McAfee. *\_The Second Machine Age - Work, Progress, and Prosperity in a Time of Brilliant Technologies\_*. New York: W. W. Norton & Company, 2016.
- Yoffie, D. and M. Cusumano. *\_Strategy Rules: Five Timeless Lessons from Bill Gates, Andy Grove, and Steve Jobs\_*. New York: HarperBusiness, 2015.